saint of heretics in the One True Church of Copenhagen.

One of the problems with writing about David Bohm is that he really was persecuted and was forced to flee across the globe at some of the most crucial points in his life, which means that many of his most interesting personal papers were lost or destroyed. Furthermore, the people who disagreed with Bohm are the people who won—and, being victors, they went about doing what victors do with history, which makes it even more difficult to separate myth from fact. And, to make things even worse, there's pushback from Bohm's defenders that takes things too far, overcompensating for the revisionist history of the orthodox camp. There's a biography of Bohm, written by his friend and colleague David Peat; he paints Bohm as a sort of secular saint with improbably clear vision about the nature of reality. Moreover, the biography is riddled with factual errors, and also takes some quotes out of context and produces others with no clear evidence that they were ever said. Finally, interest in Bohm's work increased markedly shortly after he died and shows no signs of stopping, leading to a slew of new questions that would have been easy to answer had anyone bothered to ask them of Bohm before he died in 1992. This convoluted situation has produced a remarkable number of myths and legends about a relatively obscure physicist who died well within living memory.

Those legends are important. They tell us something about the role Bohm plays in the culture of quantum physics. They also tell us about the reactions that Bohm's ideas provoked. Behind those legends is a remarkably simple theory about how the quantum world works—and the remarkably complex life of a single unfortunate and brilliant man.

We know for a fact that David Joseph Bohm was born on December 20, 1917, in Wilkes-Barre, Pennsylvania. Bohm's father, Samuel, was a Jewish immigrant from Hungary who came to Pennsylvania alone at the age of nineteen; there, he met and married Frieda Popky, a Lithuanian Jew who had come over to the United States with her family years earlier. Samuel Bohm was a down-to-earth man who owned a furniture store in town, and